



WILL INDIA FIND ITS STRIDE IN THE LONG RUN?

India's growing appetite for triathlons and hybrid races signals a **shift in fitness** culture. But will the infrastructure and access catch up?

Santadeep Dey

santadeep.dey@thehindu.co.in

A powerful revolution is beginning to take shape across India's bustling metros and sprawling peri-urban locales, as an increasing number of fitness enthusiasts continue to submit to the punishing allure of racing banners like the Ironman and HYROX.

Of course, there is the good ol' marathon, the roughly 42.2-kilometre-long no-nonsense run that will

never stop finding takers. But then again, a new breed of endurance athletes, fuelled by the hunger to redefine personal limits, are sprinting into a world where mental fortitude and brute strength are put to the test across disciplines.

The Ironman, an iconic triathlon, featuring a 3.9-km swim, 180.2-km bicycle ride, and a full-fledged marathon, and HYROX, a global